

How designer Arunika Sarkar turned the tactical rules of Rummy into a Wes Anderson-esque collectible furniture collection

By **RIDHI KALE**

If you are the type to break out in hives at the sight of colour, look away now. Kolkata-based design studio Atelier Arunika is not just ignoring the current obsession with muted neutrals, they are actively setting the safe design handbook on fire. With the debut of the Ramino Series, interior designer Arunika Sarkar is placing a high-stakes, unapologetically loud bet on narrative luxury postmodernism. This five-piece, limited-edition debut collection treats the contemporary living room as a theatrical stage, positioning furniture to behave like a fully realised character auditioning for a Wes Anderson film.

Strategy and Silhouette

Rather than committing the ultimate, unimaginative sin of literally stamping playing card silhouettes or direct suit replicas onto wood, Sarkar chooses a far more sophisticated sleight of hand. "Rather than directly replicating playing cards, the collection interprets the emotions associated with the game, joy, togetherness, curiosity and playful unpredictability through form, colour and pattern," explains Sarkar. "At its core, the Ramino Series is not about simply reproducing a card game, but about translating its emotional experience into furniture."

The Five Characters

Functioning as a family of narrative artefacts, the collection is playful yet architecturally precise across five distinct collectible pieces. Canasta Bar Cabinet stands as the theatrical centrepiece of the collection, featuring the club suit brilliantly re-engineered as an oversized, commanding central motif. "In Canasta, the connection is most explicit," says Sarkar. "This deliberate gesture transforms a familiar symbol into an expressive design feature while reinforcing the collection's playful identity." If the Jolly Console embodies the spirit of unpredictability and bold design expression, Fiore Console introduces visual softness using clusters of spherical forms to disrupt strict geometry and Cuiro Console (with storage) balances whimsy with sophistication using spherical feet and heart-shaped knobs. Then there's Picche Chest of Drawers with stacked curves and layered geometry.

Material Matters

Pulling off these gravity-defying, theatrical silhouettes and strict geometric compositions required an intense behind-the-scenes engineering marathon in the workshop. "The Ramino Series began with a process of exploration through freehand sketches before translating them into precise technical drawings," says Sarkar. To bring the digital renders to life, she developed a specialised structural cocktail. Robust standard plywood provided foundational strength, High-Density Moisture Resistant board (HDMR) allowed for crisp architectural detailing and highly pliable flexible plywood provided the material freedom needed to bend, sculpt and wrap the wood into smooth, sweeping curves. "The manufacturing journey reflects a balance between craftsmanship and experimentation, where each stage, from sketch to prototype and from colour testing to final finishing, contributes to transforming an initial idea into a fully realised design object," notes Sarkar.

But the true soul of this Wes Anderson-meets-Memphis collection relies entirely on its ultra-smooth polycoat finish. With this debut, Atelier Arunika has played an absolutely flawless hand, proving that high-end design is at its best when it refuses to play it safe.